CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

PET BOARDING / DAYCARE OWNER IN THE AI ERA

Pet parents outspend every downturn — but nobody apps their way out of a 6 a.m. kennel round.

★ TL;DR — Owners around ~$75K on the site's scale, startable in 1–6 months of setup with no professional license. The catch: it's a 365-day business — dogs don't respect holidays, they create them. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

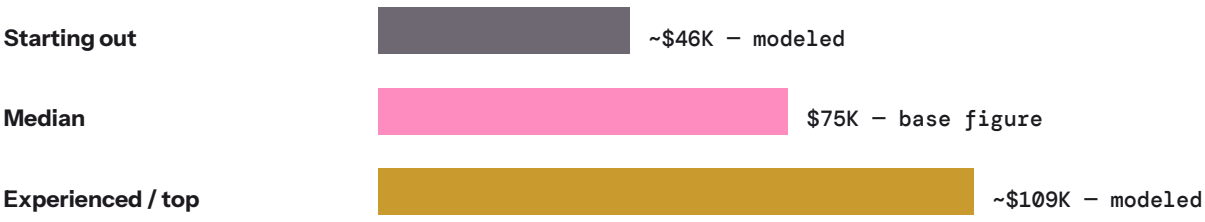
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Boarding is a capacity business: kennels full on holidays print the year.
- Daycare memberships smooth the weekdays between boarding peaks.
- Cameras and booking apps sell transparency; the care itself is staff and routine.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Pet Boarding / Daycare Owner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A PET BOARDING / DAYCARE OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Feed, exercise and supervise play groups safely
- ✓ Clean and sanitize runs, yards and bedding constantly
- ✓ Check pets in and out; send owners photo updates
- ✓ Schedule staff for 365-day coverage and emergencies

Think: a hotel where the guests can't talk, shed everywhere, and peak season is every holiday.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Booking, payments, pet-cam streaming and report-card apps handle the parent experience. Scheduling software runs the staff roster.	Reading group-play dynamics before a fight, spotting the dog that's off its food, and earning pet parents' trust — care judgment, daily.

⚠ **One disease outbreak or injury incident can define your reputation; protocols and staffing depth are survival, not polish.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Recurring daycare clients and holiday sellouts ✓ A business pet owners emotionally love and recommend ✓ Add-ons — grooming, training, photos — stack onto every stay	✗ You, or staff you pay, work every single holiday ✗ Noise, cleaning and early mornings are structural ✗ Facility rent runs 24/7 whether kennels are full or empty

Good fit? Animal-experienced, systems-minded, and unshockable about mess.
Bad fit? You want holidays off, or you underestimate the cleaning volume.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — WORK IN A FACILITY FIRST	DOOR B — START SMALL: IN-HOME OR MICRO-FACILITY
A season inside a boarding or daycare operation teaches group play, sanitation protocol and staffing reality. It's also how you learn your local demand before signing a lease.	Begin with in-home boarding or a small rented space for a handful of dogs: low overhead, waitlist-building, and proof of demand before a full-facility bet.

Smart move: Sell daycare memberships before the boarding peaks arrive — weekday subscription revenue carries the rent between holidays.
Where you land after: A full house with waitlists → a larger facility or a second location.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
STUDY THE	CHOOSE YOUR	SET UP	BUILD THE	OPEN WITH	STAFF FOR

STEP 1 — Study the care model

FREE · TODAY

- Learn group-play sizing, vaccination requirements and sanitation standards used by good facilities.
- Visit competitors as a customer; note what owners praise in reviews.

STEP 2 — Choose your scale

WEEKS

- In-home, micro-facility or full facility — capacity decides the whole model.
- Price daily boarding and daycare packages from local norms.

STEP 3 — Set up the operation

MONTHS 1-3

- Register the business and arrange insurance for animal care.
- Build intake forms: vaccines, temperament assessment, emergency contacts.

STEP 4 — Build the space and systems

MONTHS 2-4

- Runs, yards, a cleaning protocol, and a camera setup owners can peek at.
- Booking and report-card software from day one.

STEP 5 — Open with a founding offer

LAUNCH

- Daycare memberships first — a weekday base load before holiday boarding.
- Every stay ends with photos and a report card; that's the referral engine.

STEP 6 — Staff for 365

MONTH 6+

- Hire and cross-train before the first holiday sellout.
- Protocols written, not remembered: illness, fights, escapes.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: tour two facilities' websites and list their prices and rules.

- Days 1–30: model chosen; business setup and intake system drafted.
- Days 31–60: space secured or in-home setup ready; first daycare clients booked.
- Days 61–90: routines running; holiday waitlist marketing started.
- Day 90: dogs in care and memberships active — now fill the calendar.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **EVERY DAY IS A DOG DAY.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.